

will see a significant percentage of Indians having VDAs in their portfolios. Moreover, there's a robust belief in the transformative power of blockchain technology. Many see it as a game-changing innovation with enduring value. The coming times are expected to witness the unfolding of multiple use cases for blockchain, further fueling the growing interest in the market.

What are some common misconceptions or myths about crypto investing that you would like to address?

One common misconception about crypto investing is that it's purely speculative and lacks intrinsic value. In reality, crypto assets like Bitcoin and Ethereum serve as decentralized digital assets with utility and potential real-world applications. Understanding the fundamentals and underlying technology of crypto can help investors see beyond the speculative aspect and appreciate their long-term value proposition.

What factors should beginners consider before investing in crypto? How much should beginners invest in crypto, and what are some strategies for managing investment risk?

Since crypto is a new asset class, investors must begin with a modest allocation and get an understanding of the market. Like the stock market, crypto has blue-chip tokens, and to start with the investment, they must focus on blue-chip crypto assets. These assets, like Bitcoin, Ethereum, etc., are generally less volatile and they address real-world problems. For instance, Ethereum facilitates the creation of smart contracts, and a significant portion of decentralized applications (dApps) are currently built on the Ethereum blockchain. By investing in blue-chip crypto assets, beginners can mitigate some of the risks associated with the crypto market while still gaining exposure to its potential growth opportunities.

Crypto investors who have some exposure and a good portfolio must aim to maintain a well-diversified portfolio within the crypto asset class, similar to what is recommended in equity markets. Diversification helps spread risk across different assets, reducing the impact of adverse price movements on the overall portfolio. Investors must

remember the old advice - don't keep all your eggs in one basket.

Remember the golden rule: always conduct thorough research before making any investment decisions! Researching the fundamentals of crypto, understanding their utility, market demand, and potential risks are crucial steps in making informed investment choices.

Furthermore, beginners should consider employing various strategies to manage investment risk effectively. These may include setting clear investment goals, establishing stop-loss orders to limit potential losses, and regularly reviewing and rebalancing their portfolios based on changing market conditions.

Is Crypto investment for the short term, or are there options available for long-term investors as well?

The crypto market is constantly evolving for the better. It is growing to have more real-world implications, and this is bound to make it highly valuable. Staying put longer can potentially unlock opportunities to capitalize over time. This is exemplified by the HODL (Hold On for Dear Life) strategy, which has proven rewarding for long-term investors in cryptos like Bitcoin and Ethereum (ETH).

For long-term investors, exchanges have gone beyond providing buying and selling options for their investors. There are an array of products - CIP, Earn, etc. CIP or Crypto Investment Plan involves regularly investing a fixed amount into your crypto account on a weekly basis, providing a structured approach to accumulating assets over time.

What factors one should look for while choosing a crypto exchange?

For new investors stepping into the crypto space, it's crucial to select an exchange that is FIU IND compliant and follow KYC process. The first question they should ask themselves is, "Is the exchange I'm opting for a FIU IND registered entity?" The reason why I am emphasizing this is that recently the government of India blocked the URLs of non-FIU-compliant offshore exchanges. It was chaotic because millions of Indians had invested in those offshore exchanges. On the contrary, our users had nothing to

worry about. In fact, we went a step ahead and supported those investors on non-FIU compliant exchanges to safely migrate their assets to CoinDCX.

Our objective has been straightforward - let our investors concentrate on investing while we maintain the safety of their assets. CoinDCX has been meticulous about compliance, and, in fact, we are India's first FIU-IND registered exchange.

Beyond compliance, factors like trading fees, liquidity, token screening process and user experience are also crucial considerations for choosing an exchange, much like any other investment app.

Could you provide insights on the current taxation policies in India regarding crypto investments?

Well, the current taxation policies regarding crypto investments in India are quite hampering, to be honest. We're hopeful that these tax burdens will be reduced soon, and we're actively engaging in conversations with the government to address this issue. Despite these challenges, it's encouraging to see that people still see value in investing in crypto assets.

Given the current market sentiment, are you optimistic about Bitcoin and the broader market in the upcoming year?

I remain bullish on digital assets and the wider crypto industry for 2024 and on a long-term horizon. On the regulatory front, recent developments in India have been quite encouraging for Indian crypto players like us. The move to bring exchanges under the PMLA guidelines and the mandatory requirement for exchanges to be FIU India compliant are significant steps. These regulatory measures contribute to the safety and security of investors, which is paramount for the long-term health of the market.

Today, India stands at the forefront of crypto adoption, and Indian investors are eagerly anticipating the bull run. It's heartening to witness crypto assets, once viewed with skepticism, gaining acceptance through knowledge and experience. From No Bitcoin to KNOW Bitcoin, witnessing the narrative shift from skepticism to TRUST is immensely satisfying.